



LG XNote R405

The configuration is a (common) Core 2 Duo T5550 (1.83 GHz), which is coupled with 1 GB of RAM, and a Radeon Xpress 1250 solution. For Rs 40,000, the R405 is well built, and rugged, and offers a solid portable computing experience sans some of the performance. It's not a high-end configuration or even a fast configuration so demanding mobile warriors will give this a miss.

WORKHORSES ABOVE RS 40,000: Thoroughbreds

HP DV2701TX

Touted as a "special edition", one look at the beautiful design in subtle gold, silver and brown on the cover and inner body will tell you why. With a smooth finish that weathers beautifully, HP's DV2701TX is a very attractive notebook, with a profile which when viewed from the side tapers from slim to slimmer as one's vision moves from the top of the keyboard towards the palm rest. The silk-like finish exudes quality and so does the soft touch, bevelled keypad. The soft-blue backlit multimedia controls are touch activated and both look and work beautifully.

14.1 inches and a superb form factor, gives you the best of both worlds—functionality and flexibil-

ity on one hand, and portability on the other. It's not bulky to cart around as a 15.4-inch notebook, and not as diminutive as a 12.1-inch screen. Incidentally, the screen is beautiful and crisp. As far as a multimedia notebook goes this one has a good graphics solution, a GeForce 8400GS and features an HDMI connect. While HP, could have used a faster processor, we'd really like to see more memory, 1 GB is a little skimpy.

With an excellent screen, good graphics, a great keypad, and some mighty funky (yet functional) touch controls the HP DV2701TX is a winner in many ways, including price. At Rs 46,990, it's a must buy.



HP DV2701TX

Lenovo Y510

The 'Y' series introduces Lenovo to the entertainment hemisphere, a realm where looks, performance, and functionality are of utmost importance, although—not in that order. The Y510 is a well-built notebook. The hinge system looks neat and when open reveals five LEDs, which are battery indicators. The piano black finish is well done, but at no point comes across as loud. If anything we'd complain about, would be an entertainment / multimedia geared notebook being so boxy. The backlit, touch multimedia controls work well, and we like the tasteful

orange lighting, which goes well with the black and grey body colour scheme. The screen, while crisp and bright, is a glossy panel, and reflections will cause havoc with multimedia content in particular.

What we would like to see, is more memory for one thing (1 GB is so slow with Windows Vista), and a decent graphics solution (X3100 is strictly for non-multimedia work). Lenovo provides heaps of software on their notebooks and the Y510 was no exception. With MS Office 2007, Adobe Elements, Norton Antivirus, and a host of other multimedia and utilitarian software, the Y510 is a fully loaded solution (if only on the software side). Another nifty utility is the face recognition software that allows you to login on the basis of your face. While not as fast as a fingerprint reader, any kind of biometrics device on a notebook is just cool.

In terms of performance, the T5450 on the Y510 is no slouch, but gets left behind by the T7xxx series and latest T8xxx series. In multimedia tests, the lack of dedicated graphics also pinches, and you will face problems viewing HD content on this one, and don't even dream about the odd game. At Rs 48,490, the Y510 is reasonably priced for a notebook and is a solid solution for office users, but we'd like to see better hardware under the hood next time.



Lenovo Y510